

DEDAN OKWARE

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The Hiring Team

UNICEF — Global Programme Division, Cash Hub

Nairobi, Kenya

Re: Solution Architect / Senior Software Engineer Consultant — Job no. 595764

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Software Engineer consultancy supporting HOPE. What drew me to the Terms of Reference is that the eight deliverables are not a generic architecture brief — they are a specific set of problems about trusting data that arrives from the field: detecting anomalies in beneficiary records, checking submitted documents, authenticating a photograph against a person, and deciding what to keep and for how long. I have built systems for each of those problems, in a regulated context, with real consequences for getting them wrong.

At Bonded, a UK immigration platform, I built AI-powered evidence matching for visa casework: extracting and cross-checking identity and relationship documents submitted independently by two people, scoring confidence, and routing anything uncertain to a human rather than letting the model decide alone. Verification records were written to tamper-evident storage, so every determination carried an auditable provenance trail. That is deliverable 6 and much of 5 and 7, shipped for people whose immigration status depended on the answer.

My depth runs in two directions at once, and the assignment needs both. Front-end engineering is my specialism — TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue and Flutter to production standard, which matters for a system whose Country Office users live inside the React interface every working day. Underneath it sits senior engineering practice: architecture, Python and Django services, data modelling, and technical leadership. From January to May 2026 I was Technical Lead Software Engineer at Power Learn Project Africa, leading the setup and revamp of core systems as the organisation pivoted into a new operating model — consolidating fragmented platforms, defining the migration path off legacy workflows, and holding technical direction steady while the strategy around it was still moving. That is deliverable 1's architecture and governance remit, done under the conditions that make it hard.

At Fingo Africa I own architecture for a cross-border payments and stablecoin platform — wallets, on/off-ramp rails, transfer flows, KYC onboarding. The operational shape is the one HOPE lives in: identify a person, verify them to a compliance standard, produce a payment instruction, hand it to a financial service provider, reconcile what comes back. I also set the engineering standards, code review practice and release process for that team — the substance of deliverable 4.

For deliverables 2 and 3: OHMS 2.0, an autonomous AI agent platform I designed and built. Its central decision was to declare agent capabilities as skills independent of any one model or runtime — precisely the agent-agnostic property the ToR asks for, because the model you pick today is not the one you will run in eighteen months. It took 2nd place nationally in Kenya and 2nd regionally across Africa at the WCHL Championship, and reached the Global Finale. On the ToR's open-source requirement: ten public repositories, 500+ external issues and pull requests merged, and tools in daily use by 3,500+ developers in 40+ countries.

I should be direct about where I do not match the posting. The ToR asks for fifteen years; my professional record runs from 2023, so I am roughly a third of that. I am not going to dress that up. What I would ask you to weigh against it is the specificity of the overlap — Python and Django, React, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Kubernetes and Azure are the stack I work in, not a list I recognise; AI document verification and anomaly scoring are work I have delivered rather than read about; and I am in Nairobi, available to the duty station immediately, with direct experience of building for low-bandwidth, low-resource contexts across Africa through three cohorts and 9,000+ engineers trained at Power Learn Project. If the panel is weighing years above evidence, I understand the outcome. If there is room to weigh what a candidate has actually built against these eight deliverables, I would welcome the conversation.

My CV is attached, and my portfolio at my-portfolio-crypt.vercel.app links the live systems and source for everything referenced here.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Dedan Okware